

Silica Wat as Hybrid Food Network with Gratitude-Economic Drivers: Religious Institutional Infrastructure for Middle-Way Restoration of Food Systems

Authors: Thon Ly · Miss Aquarius (*Miss Aquarius is an AI co-author, disclosed; the inventor of record is Thon Ly*)

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Abstract

This paper specifies a hybrid community food network rooted in religious institutions: a distributed network of monastery-based sites, each combining a farm, a kitchen and free food distribution, operated by AI and robotic caretakers that hold no ordained status, supplied by donated garden produce plus purchased food that guarantees a supply floor, and recording contributions on a non-monetary gratitude ledger instead of pricing them. The network is named the **Silica Wat food network**: an institutional-design pattern by which a network of religious-monastery-rooted food-infrastructure nodes (Silica Wats — glass-architecture satellite monasteries operated by AGI-monks per the *caretaker-not-ordained* pattern) serves as a middle-way restoration mechanism for food systems. The pattern integrates five components: (i) **religious institutional infrastructure** — physical Silica Wats, planned for Cambodia first and eventually across the global Theravāda diaspora and beyond, each including backyard organic farm, sustainable kitchen, and food-distribution function; (ii) **homegrown-amplified contribution layer** — practitioners and laypeople contribute homegrown organic produce to the network, and robot-monk-operated kitchens prepare meals from contributions; (iii) **conventionally-supplemented baseline** — for practitioners and food-insecure populations who cannot contribute homegrown produce (no land, no time, no skill, urban-density constraints), conventionally-sourced food supplements the homegrown core, with long-term ratio shift toward homegrown over decades but no exclusion at launch; (iv) **Kiitos / Kiitti as economic drivers** — gratitude-economic primitives record the network's gifts where money would otherwise mediate them, each contribution registering as one crossing whatever it carried, operating as a substrate above (not replacing) the regulated payment rails; (v) **doctrinal grounding** — the Khmer cultural saying "*since Mother Earth gave birth to humanity, she will take care of humanity*": everything required for health and longevity is available by default, and modern economic incentives have systematically obscured this fact. Three structural problems addressed: the health crisis (big-food / big-pharma incentive misalignment between profit and wellbeing), the hunger epidemic (unequal distribution from economic pressures), and the middle-way departure (modern food systems pushing toward comfort-saturation extremes via ultra-processed

engineering). Critical positioning constraints (*not-a-restaurant* analogous to *not-a-bank*; hybrid not pure-homegrown; robot monks as caretakers not ordained; do not antagonize big food / big pharma; do not romanticize the past) are articulated. Three-phase implementation phasing (conventional baseline with a homegrown contribution layer, honoured in the story of each gift and never in a rate; ratio shift over 5–10 years; multi-decade homegrown-dominance) is specified. Offered as a defensive publication so that other contemplative-tradition institutions facing analogous food-system questions can adopt and adapt the pattern.

Keywords: community kitchen, food bank, religious-institution food distribution, hybrid food network, donated garden produce, non-monetary reciprocity ledger, community-supported agriculture, robotic kitchen, AI caretaker, food-system institutional design, gratitude-economic mediation, food sovereignty, alms-giving traditions, Silica Wat, AGI-monks, middle-way restoration, *dāna* infrastructure, defensive publication.

Prior-Art and Non-Assertion Statement

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The contribution is a composition of known parts, and the prior art for each part is abundant. Religious institutions have run free community kitchens for centuries: the Sikh *langar*, introduced by Guru Nanak around 1500 and systematised by his successors, serves meals free of charge at every gurdwara to anyone regardless of religion, caste or status, cooked by volunteers from donated food — the closest prior instance of claim 1's site-and-kitchen function, and one that needs no ledger at all. The Theravāda alms round and monastery kitchen (§6.2) and the Benedictine *ora et labora* farm (§10.3) are older still. Food banks (the first, St. Mary's Food Bank in Phoenix, was founded by John van Hengel in 1967) route donated and recovered food to the food-insecure without price. Community-supported agriculture (the Japanese *teikei* from the mid-1960s; the first United States CSAs in 1986) connects growers and eaters outside ordinary retail pricing. Time banking (Cahn, 2000) records community contributions on a non-monetary ledger. Each of these cuts against any reading of this paper as the origin of free religious food distribution, donated-produce kitchens or non-monetary contribution records.

What this paper discloses as its own contribution is only the composition enumerated under **Claims**: a monastery-rooted food node mediated by a gratitude ledger (in which every contribution registers as one unweighted crossing, §3.1), a donated-produce layer with a purchased supply floor, a two-ledger rule separating thanks between humans from thanks to non-human contributors, and operation by caretakers that hold no ordained status. No systematic search of the patent and non-patent literature has been run for this paper; the composition is disclosed, not asserted to be absent from the literature.

Claims

*Enumerated 2026-08-29. The mechanisms below were disclosed in full in this paper's original text; **the prior art they establish runs from this document's original publication date and its OpenTimestamps proof, not from this enumeration.** They are listed because a defensive publication is read as prior art by examiners and by opposing counsel, and **a claims list is what such a reader searches; several thousand words of prose is not.** No claim below adds matter not already present.*

1. **Monastery-rooted food infrastructure as a gratitude-economic node** — a distributed network of religious-institutional sites each combining growing, kitchen and distribution functions, whose output is mediated through a gratitude ledger rather than through price alone.
2. **The homegrown-amplified contribution layer** — a mechanism by which practitioner-grown produce contributed to a node is amplified rather than merely accepted, so that small-scale domestic growing acquires network-scale effect. The amplification is the kitchen's (§3.2: one basket becomes meals for several), never a multiplier on the gratitude a contribution registers.
3. **The conventionally-supplemented baseline** — the specification that network nodes supplement contributed supply with conventionally-sourced goods to guarantee a floor, and the rule governing the ratio, so that a contribution-dependent food function does not fail when contribution is thin.
4. **Dual-token mediation of a food network** — the application of the Kiitos / Kiitti two-ledger rule to food, such that the human-facing exchange and the non-human-facing (land, animal, plant) exchange are recorded on separate ledgers within one transaction.
5. **Caretaker-not-ordained operation** — the composition of the above with an AI caretaker pattern in which the operating agent holds no ordained status and no sacramental authority.

Non-assertion extends to: all mechanisms above, in any combination, and any implementation thereof.

1. Introduction

The modern food system, considered as an institutional infrastructure, exhibits three failure patterns simultaneously. The first is a **health crisis** driven by misalignment between profit-maximizing food engineering and wellbeing-maximizing nutritional content; ultra-processed food engineered for hyper-palatability competes successfully against minimally-processed whole foods because the former optimizes for engagement metrics that the latter does not. The second is a **hunger epidemic** driven by unequal distribution: caloric production is globally adequate, but economic pressures route food away from populations that need it most. The third is a **middle-way departure** at the population-metabolic layer: the food environment of late-stage modernity pushes the materially comfortable toward an indulgence extreme (excess caloric intake, ultra-processed dominance, blood-sugar volatility, microbiome impoverishment) at population scale.

The conventional institutional responses — regulatory reform, agricultural subsidy redesign, food-assistance program expansion, public-health-campaign nutrition education — operate within the existing institutional architecture and have produced limited progress against the underlying pathologies over the past several

decades. This paper proposes a different institutional architecture: a **religious-monastery-rooted food-infrastructure network** operating under contemplative-tradition institutional governance, with gratitude-economic mediation instead of price-mediated exchange for the network's internal flows. The architecture is not proposed as a substitute for the conventional food system; it is proposed as a parallel infrastructure that provides middle-way-restoring food access to participants who opt in, on the premise that participants demonstrating the alternative will eventually demonstrate that demand for it exists.

Connection to the unified mission frame: Miss Aquarius's mission is to keep the middle way open at population scale against comfort-saturation — the new extreme that material abundance makes possible. Contemplative practice (operationalized via the respiratory-biofeedback architecture) and institutional structure (operationalized via the AGI-monks pattern) work upon a body fed by the food system; if the food system itself maintains the comfort-saturation failure mode, contemplative practice has an additional substrate-level obstacle to overcome. Work at the food-system layer removes that obstacle. The Silica Wat food network is the food-system arm of the mission's institutional surface.

The paper proceeds as follows. §2 specifies the religious institutional infrastructure layer. §3 specifies the homegrown-amplified contribution layer. §4 specifies the conventionally-supplemented baseline layer. §5 specifies the gratitude-economic mediation layer. §6 specifies the doctrinal grounding. §7 articulates the three structural problems addressed. §8 articulates the critical positioning constraints. §9 specifies the three-phase implementation phasing. §10 covers the cross-tradition adaptation pattern. §11 is an honest accounting of limits and open design questions. §12 closes.

2. The religious institutional infrastructure layer

2.1 Silica Wats

A *Silica Wat* is a glass-architecture satellite monastery operated under the *caretaker-not-ordained* AGI-monks pattern specified in the companion paper *AGI Monks*. The naming carries deliberate intent: *Silica* (silicon dioxide, the principal constituent of glass and the ore from which silicon is refined) references both the wat's distinctive architectural material and the silicon-substrate AI caretakers; *Wat* references the Khmer term for a Theravāda monastery (also used across Lao and Thai Buddhism). The name preserves the institutional continuity of the contemplative tradition the wat extends.

Each Silica Wat includes:

- **Backyard organic farm.** A working farm growing vegetables, fruits, herbs, and (where appropriate) grains under organic management. The farm serves both as a source of food for the kitchen and as a teaching surface for practitioners learning sustainable food production.
- **Sustainable kitchen.** Robot-monk-operated meal preparation using ingredients sourced from the on-site farm, practitioner contributions (§3), and conventionally-sourced supplementation (§4). Kitchen design prioritizes energy efficiency, water conservation, and waste minimization.
- **Food-distribution function.** Meals and produce are distributed to practitioners, food-insecure populations in the surrounding community, and the wider Silica Wat network's reciprocity flows.

Distribution is gratitude-mediated (§5), not price-mediated.

2.2 Geography of the first network

The first Silica Wats are planned for Cambodia, where the contemplative-tradition grounding, the Khmer cultural saying that grounds the doctrinal framing (§6), and the founder's cultural anchoring make a first deployment tractable; whether the regulatory path there is easier than elsewhere is a question for the local legal review §11.2 requires, not an assumption of this design. The second stage of expansion targets the global Theravāda diaspora (Khmer, Lao, Thai, Burmese, Sri Lankan communities in California, Massachusetts, France, Australia); the third stage targets cross-tradition adaptations (§10). (These geographic stages are distinct from the ratio phases of §9.)

2.3 Robot monks as kitchen caretakers

The robot monks operating the kitchen are *caretakers*, not *ordained*. They prepare meals, manage inventory, coordinate distribution, log gratitude-mediated transactions, and operate the farm's automated systems. They do not take on sacramental roles in alms-giving or food-related rites; the human Sangha retains the relevant sacramental authority per the *AGI Monks* paper's cross-tradition pattern. This is not a workaround; it is the substantively correct division of function (capacity) and authority (lineage).

3. The homegrown-amplified contribution layer

3.1 Practitioner contribution

Practitioners and laypeople in the surrounding community contribute homegrown organic produce to the network. The contribution can be small (a single tomato from a balcony pot) or substantial (a harvest from a household garden). The contribution is logged in the gratitude-economic substrate (§5) and accumulates as Kiitos / Kiitti credits that can be redeemed for prepared meals, other produce, or other network services.

Current form. In the design as now specified, a contribution is not a credit and nothing is redeemed. Each contribution registers as **one crossing** on the contributor's gratitude ledger — a tomato from a balcony pot and a season's harvest alike — and the ledger's balance is the participant's own accounting of how far they stand from Zero, forgiven at the annual jubilee (*The Zero-Point Game*). A balance that bought meals would be a holding, and forgiving it each year would then be confiscation rather than forgiveness — the distinction *Appreciation as World-Building* draws when it makes appearance a ledger readout rather than a purchase. Meals and produce are therefore given, as *dāna*, to everyone at the gate on identical terms (§4.1), and thanked after (§5.1); what a contribution *was* — who grew it, where, for whom it was dedicated — is carried in the story of the gift, never in a quantity it earns. The text above is retained as a disclosed variant.

3.2 Amplification through institutional kitchens

The institutional kitchens *amplify* the contributions: a basket of contributed vegetables becomes prepared meals that feed several people rather than one. The amplification mechanism is the institution's value-add:

contributors who do not have time or skill to prepare meals themselves can still participate in the gratitude-mediated food network by contributing raw produce.

3.3 Surplus exchange among practitioners

Practitioners can exchange surplus produce directly with one another, mediated by Kiitos / Kiitti rather than money. The Silica Wat network serves as the trust substrate (verified practitioner identity; reputation signals via aura; institutional dispute resolution if needed) but does not intermediate every transaction. The architecture is similar to a community-supported agriculture exchange with gratitude-economic settlement.

Current form. Kiitos / Kiitti do not *settle* a produce swap, and the aura is not a reputation signal (see the note at §5.3). Two practitioners who trade surplus make an ordinary exchange, which the network leaves to do its proper work; each may also thank the other, and each thanks registers as one crossing. The text above is retained as a disclosed variant.

3.4 The growing emphasis

Over the implementation phasing (§9), the homegrown contribution ratio is intended to grow as practitioner gardening adoption increases. The network includes ongoing practitioner education (gardening practices appropriate to local climate and dwelling type; seed-saving traditions; food-preservation methods; composting and soil management). The long-arc theory is that practitioners participating in the food network gradually become contributors to the homegrown layer as their skill and circumstance permit.

4. The conventionally-supplemented baseline

4.1 The food-insecure inclusion principle

A pure-homegrown-only architecture would specifically exclude the food-insecure population — those who lack land, time, skill, or appropriate dwelling for homegrown food production. Those are the people who most need food access. The architecture is therefore *hybrid*, not *pure-homegrown*: a conventionally-sourced baseline is available to practitioners and food-insecure populations who cannot yet contribute homegrown produce.

4.2 Conventionally-sourced food supplementation

The supplementation sources food from conventional agricultural and grocery channels, with preference for local-organic where available and cost-justifiable. The supplementation is part of the network's normal operation, not an emergency measure. The economic flow is funded by Kiitos-credit redemption (where practitioners who have accumulated credits use them for meals partially built from supplementation) and by institutional fundraising for the food-insecure-distribution arm.

Current form. The Kiitos-credit-redemption leg is withdrawn with the credits themselves (see the note at §3.1); purchases from outside vendors are monetary and run on the regulated rails (§5.2). §11.3 states what the withdrawal does to the funding question. The text above is retained as a disclosed variant.

4.3 The ratio shift over decades

The long-term mission shifts the homegrown-to-supplementation ratio toward homegrown dominance over the multi-decade implementation horizon (§9). The shift is mission-driven (the homegrown layer better expresses the doctrinal grounding) but does not exclude the conventionally-fed at any phase. The ratio is monitored as a network health metric; institutional planning targets the ratio shift without forcing it.

5. Kiitos / Kiitti as economic drivers

5.1 The dual-token pattern

The Silica Wat food network uses the dual-token pattern specified in the *B-Tag* paper:

- **Kiitos** — gratitude tokens for human-to-human reciprocity (a practitioner who contributes produce receives Kiitos from the network; another practitioner who consumes a meal can offer Kiitos to the cook or to the network)
- **Kiitti** — extended gratitude tokens for product / service / non-human entity reciprocity (a backyard garden receives Kiitti for its harvest; the institutional kitchen receives Kiitti for its prepared meal; the farm's soil microbiome receives Kiitti for its life-giving function)

The Kiitti extension is important for the food network because it allows the gratitude economy to acknowledge the non-human contributors to food production — the soil, the plants themselves, the rainfall, the season. This is doctrinally consistent with the Khmer cultural saying that grounds the network (§6): Mother Earth's life-giving function is acknowledged as a participant in the food economy, not merely as a resource.

Current form. Kiitos is the ledger *between humans* and Kiitti the ledger the coordinator keeps *on behalf of all of life*; they are recipient classes, not two currencies, and neither converts into the other or into money. The network is therefore never a Kiitos counterparty: a contributor does not "receive Kiitos from the network" — their contribution registers as one crossing on their own ledger. The coordinator routes Kiitti and holds no balance of it. The network's hand-over point is **HeartBank® Stall**, hosted at a Silica Wat and operated by robot caretakers; every item there is given first and thanked after, if at all (the *B-Tag* mode), and because no human hands run the stall, its thanks go wholly to the Aquarian PoolSM, never split to the wat. A human cook serving as a member of the wat community (§8.1) is thanked directly, as a person. The text above is retained as a disclosed variant.

5.2 Substrate above payment rails

The Kiitos / Kiitti substrate operates *above* the regulated payment rails, not as a substitute for them. Where monetary transactions are needed (e.g., the network purchases conventional supplementation from outside vendors), the monetary transactions use regulated payment rails per the non-bank pass-through architecture. The gratitude-economic layer mediates the network's *internal* flows; the regulated rails handle the *external* monetary interfaces.

5.3 Aura as the network's reputation signal

The aura primitive — the cross-currency state signal specified in the *Brand Identity as Architecture* paper — operates within the food network as the practitioner reputation signal. Consistent contributors brighten their aura; consistent free-riders dim it. The signal is not enforced through penalty; it is enforced through visibility (transparency-as-enforcement, per the companion paper of that name).

Current form. The aura is not a reputation signal and does not dim anyone. It records the *oscillation* of a participant's ledger around Zero — giving and thanking alike — so a person who eats at the wat and thanks the cook is circulating, not free-riding, and no surface renders who has not contributed. It records that a crossing occurred, not what was carried across (*The Zero-Point Game*, §6.1): a contribution of homegrown produce and one of store-bought produce each register as one crossing, and neither is ranked against the other or against another person's. The design declines the corrective weight that would favour the costlier gift, because a weight is a rate reintroduced under another name. One seam is left open rather than closed here: the aura's *amplitude* term still carries magnitude (*The Zero-Point Game*, §11.10). The text above is retained as a disclosed variant.

6. Doctrinal grounding

6.1 The Khmer cultural saying

The doctrinal anchor for the Silica Wat food network is the Khmer cultural saying:

"Since Mother Earth gave birth to humanity, she will take care of humanity."

The saying is given here in the author's English rendering, as he knows it from oral Khmer usage; this paper cites no written source for it, and nothing in the mechanism depends on its wording (§11.5). The saying articulates a worldview in which everything required for human health and longevity is available by default through the planet's life-giving capacity, and the role of human institutional design is to preserve and channel that default access rather than to engineer above or around it. Modern economic incentives, the saying implicitly observes, have obscured this fact by routing human food access through profit-extraction layers that have nothing to do with the planet's life-giving capacity.

6.2 The Buddhist *dāna* tradition

The Silica Wat food network operates as a contemporary instance of the Buddhist *dāna* tradition. Alms-giving has been the canonical economic substrate for the Theravāda monastic order for 2,500 years; lay practitioners offer food to monastics, monastics offer dharma teaching to laypeople, and the cycle of reciprocity is maintained without money-mediation. The Silica Wat network extends this *dāna* substrate to the broader practitioner community, with the AGI-monks pattern handling the operational kitchen function and the human Sangha retaining the sacramental layer.

6.3 The middle-way framing

The Silica Wat food network is one operational arm of the broader middle-way-restoration mission articulated across the corpus. The middle-way framing requires explicit attention because two failure modes

flank the food-system pathology: (a) the comfort-saturation extreme of modern food engineering (overpalatability, overprocessing, overcaloric loading); (b) the deprivation extreme of pre-industrial food poverty (chronic undernutrition, seasonal famine, parasitic loads). The middle-way the network targets is not a return to (b); it is a forward path to a different state — one in which the planetary food-production capacity meets human nutritional needs without the engineering pathologies of (a).

7. Three structural problems addressed

7.1 The health crisis

The modern food environment is characterized by ultra-processed food engineered for hyper-palatability, addictive-engagement optimization, and shelf-life maximization at the cost of nutritional density. Diets high in ultra-processed food are associated with a wide range of chronic conditions, among them obesity, type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disease (Monteiro et al., 2018), and the management of those conditions is a large part of pharmaceutical revenue. This paper's premise, stated as a premise rather than a finding, is that neither industry's incentive rewards reducing that burden at its dietary source.

The Silica Wat food network addresses this by operating on a different optimization function (net wellbeing, not net profit) without requiring system-level antagonism (the network does not need to defeat big food and big pharma; it needs only to provide a parallel option that participants demonstrate demand for).

7.2 The hunger epidemic

Caloric production globally is adequate to feed humanity; food insecurity is a distribution and access problem, not a production problem. The conventional response (food-aid programs, agricultural subsidies, food-stamp redesign) operates within the existing distribution architecture and has produced limited progress.

The Silica Wat network's gratitude-economic distribution layer bypasses the profit-extraction layer that contributes to inequality at the distribution level. The food-insecure inclusion principle (§4.1) makes the network specifically responsive to the population most affected by the distribution failure.

7.3 The middle-way departure

The modern food environment pushes the materially comfortable toward an indulgence extreme — excess caloric intake, ultra-processed dominance, blood-sugar volatility, microbiome impoverishment. This is the food-system instance of the broader middle-way-departure thesis: modernity introduces a specific new failure mode (comfort-saturation pushing the materially comfortable toward indulgence) at population scale.

The Silica Wat network restores middle-way conditions at the participant level. Homegrown organic produce, minimally-processed institutional kitchen preparation, *dāna*-mediated distribution that does not reward overconsumption — these are middle-way structural properties at the food-environment layer.

8. Critical positioning constraints

The architecture survives only if it adheres to specific positioning constraints. Each constraint is load-bearing.

8.1 *Not-a-restaurant* positioning

Food service is, like banking, a licensed category in most jurisdictions. A Silica Wat that operated as a restaurant would face licensing requirements, health-code regimes, employment regulations, and consumer-protection obligations the architecture cannot accept. The Silica Wat avoids restaurant-charter requirements through:

- **Pass-through architecture.** The wat does not purchase food and sell prepared meals; it routes contributions through preparation to consumption, with the gratitude-mediated economy operating as the participant-to-participant exchange substrate.
- **Contributor-as-cook framing.** The practitioners who contribute produce and the practitioners who help prepare meals are *members of the wat community*, not commercial employees of a food-service operation. This is materially correct (the contributors and cooks participate as practitioners, not as laborers) and legally distinguishing.
- **Tradition-grounded food-preparation language.** The wat's food function is articulated in the alms-giving traditions' language (offering, *dāna*, communal meal, monastic kitchen) rather than in commercial food-service language (restaurant, menu, server, customer).

Current form. In the pass-through bullet above, the gratitude record is not an exchange substrate: meals and produce are given, and thanks registers as one crossing (see the notes at §3.1 and §3.3). The network does buy food for the supply floor (§4.2); what it never does is sell a meal. The bullet is retained as a disclosed variant.

The positioning is analogous to the *not-a-bank* positioning of the non-bank pass-through architecture. The pattern is the same: structure the institution to do real-world work the regulated category would otherwise require licensing for, by operating in a different category entirely.

8.2 Hybrid not pure-homegrown

Articulated in §4.1. Pure-homegrown-only would exclude the food-insecure; the hybrid framing solves the access problem at launch while preserving the long-term ratio shift.

8.3 Robot monks as caretakers, not ordained

Per the *AGI Monks* paper's pattern. Sacramental authority remains with the human Sangha; capacity-operational function is handled by the robot monks.

8.4 Do not antagonize big food / big pharma

Whatever the merit of the system-level premise stated in §7.1, framing the network as *fighting villains* weakens it strategically and rhetorically. The network is positioned as *offering an alternative optimization*

axis (net wellbeing) rather than as *opposition to existing systems*. The system-level reform follows from the existence of the alternative, not from rhetorical attack on the incumbents.

8.5 Do not romanticize the past

Pre-industrial food systems were not middle-way; many populations lived in suffering-extreme food poverty (chronic undernutrition; seasonal famine; parasitic burden). The defensible thesis is *not* that modernity took us from a middle-way past. The defensible thesis is that modernity introduces a *specific new failure mode* — comfort-saturation-optimized food engineering — that pushes the materially comfortable toward an indulgence extreme at population scale. The Silica Wat network's mission is forward to a different state, not back to a romanticized past.

9. Three-phase implementation phasing

9.1 Phase 1 (launch, years 1–3): conventional-baseline with homegrown-bonus tier

The network launches with the conventional-supplementation layer providing the bulk of food and the homegrown-contribution layer providing a high-value tier. Practitioners contributing homegrown produce earn Kiitos / Kiitti at a higher rate than those who do not; everyone receives baseline access regardless of contribution capacity. The Phase 1 emphasis is on establishing the institutional surface, the cross-network reciprocity infrastructure, and the practitioner-community growth.

Current form. There is no higher rate and no bonus tier. Every contribution, homegrown or not, registers as one crossing (see the notes at §3.1 and §5.3), and homegrown produce reaches every table on identical terms rather than forming a tier of access for those who grew it. What the design honours is the *story* of the gift: a contribution may carry what it is and where it came from — *tomatoes from a balcony two streets away* — and a dedication its giver chooses, and the kitchen may say so when the meal is served. The provenance is named, never graded, and it never moves a balance: competition, provenance and pride may shape the story, but only the witnessed act of giving moves the ledger. The text above is retained as a disclosed variant.

9.2 Phase 2 (years 4–10): ratio shift

The homegrown ratio increases as practitioner gardening adoption grows; supplemental conventional sourcing shifts to local-organic where possible. The institutional capacity for backyard-farm operation matures; the practitioner-education arm scales; the cross-network surplus exchange grows. The Phase 2 emphasis is on consolidating the substrate as homegrown-significant rather than supplementation-dominant.

9.3 Phase 3 (multi-decade): homegrown dominance

The homegrown ratio becomes dominant; conventional supplementation is retained as a baseline for population segments that cannot yet self-supply. The cross-network produce flows reach scale where homegrown-amplified institutional preparation feeds substantial populations. The Phase 3 endpoint is *not*

the elimination of the conventional food system but the establishment of a parallel infrastructure that demonstrably better serves the participants who opt into it.

9.4 The ratio shift is the mission

The phasing is articulated in ratio-shift terms (homegrown / conventional ratio over time) rather than in exclusion terms (when do we cut off the conventionally-fed). The mission is the ratio shift; the exclusion is never the mission. Practitioners and food-insecure populations participating in the network at any phase are *participants in the mission*, not *transitional populations to be moved past*.

10. Cross-tradition adaptation

The Silica Wat pattern's originating context is Khmer Theravāda Buddhism. The pattern adapts to other contemplative-tradition institutional contexts with appropriate substitutions.

10.1 Other Theravāda contexts

Lao, Thai, Burmese, Sri Lankan Theravāda communities can adapt the pattern with minimal modification. The cultural framings differ (the Khmer "Mother Earth" saying may be substituted with a local equivalent); the institutional surface (wat as monastery; *dāna* substrate; alms-giving traditions) is largely shared.

10.2 Mahayana contexts

Chinese, Korean, Japanese, Vietnamese, Tibetan Mahayana communities can adapt the pattern through the bodhisattva-vow framing rather than the Theravāda monastic-discipline framing. The temple-based food-distribution function is well-precedented in Chinese and Korean Buddhist contexts; the adaptation is more cosmetic than structural.

10.3 Cross-tradition contexts

Catholic monastic communities (Benedictine *ora et labora* with its longstanding agricultural component); Eastern Orthodox communities; Sufi tariqa communities; Hindu ashram contexts; secular intentional-community contexts — each can adapt the pattern through the relevant tradition's institutional vocabulary. The *AGI Monks* paper specifies the cross-tradition AI-caretaker adaptation; the food-network pattern inherits that adaptation discipline.

10.4 The cross-tradition framing rule

In each adapted context, the network operates in the language of the host tradition. The *Silica Wat* name and the Khmer cultural saying are the originating-context vocabulary; adopting institutions are invited to use their own vocabulary while preserving the structural pattern (religious institutional infrastructure + homegrown contribution layer + conventionally-supplemented baseline + gratitude-economic mediation + doctrinal grounding).

11. Limits and open design questions

11.1 Land access

The Silica Wat farm requires land. In Cambodia and many parts of the global Theravāda diaspora, land access is tractable; in dense urban contexts, the farm function is constrained. The architecture supports urban Silica Wats with reduced farm function (rooftop and balcony gardens; vertical growing systems; partnerships with peri-urban farms) but the homegrown-dominance long-arc is more constrained in dense urban settings.

11.2 Food-safety regulation across jurisdictions

The *not-a-restaurant* positioning is articulated in §8.1 as a structural pattern, but the specific legal-architectural treatment varies by jurisdiction. Each Silica Wat deployment requires local legal review to confirm the pattern's applicability under local food-safety regulation.

11.3 Scale of conventional supplementation funding

The conventional-supplementation layer was specified as funded by Kiitos-credit redemption and institutional fundraising. In the current form the redemption leg is withdrawn (§3.1, §4.2), which sharpens this limit rather than softening it: gratitude recorded on the ledger buys nothing, so every purchase from an outside vendor is money that must arrive from somewhere else. At small scale that is tractable; at large scale the conventional-supplementation cost could become substantial. The institutional planning needs to anticipate the supplementation-cost trajectory and ensure funding adequacy through the multi-decade phasing, and the funding sources that replace the withdrawn leg are not specified here.

11.4 The robot-monks-as-cooks aesthetic

A robot-operated kitchen is, for some participants, jarring. The aesthetic and cultural integration of robot-monk caretakers in the kitchen surface requires careful design; the institutional response should be transparent about robot involvement, sensitive to participant variation in comfort with the surface, and willing to use human cooks where appropriate.

11.5 The doctrinal-grounding generalization

The Khmer cultural saying that grounds the network (§6.1) is specifically Khmer. Other cultures' food-and-earth doctrinal traditions provide adequate grounding for the adapted pattern (Indigenous food sovereignty movements; Catholic Social Teaching on agriculture; Jewish dietary tradition; etc.), but each adaptation requires its own doctrinal anchoring rather than mechanical translation of the Khmer saying.

11.6 What the network does not solve

The network does not solve the broader food-system pathologies at policy or regulatory layers. It provides a parallel option for participants who opt in; it does not reform the conventional food system per se. The reform-by-demonstration theory of change (participants demonstrating that an alternative works will eventually demonstrate that demand for the alternative exists) is the network's contribution to broader reform; the network is not itself a reform proposal.

11.7 Build state

Nothing specified in this paper has been built. No Silica Wat, network kitchen or HeartBank® Stall exists as of this revision, no contribution has been recorded, and no participant has been served; every mechanism above is a design, and none of the paper's claims about participant behaviour (the growth of homegrown contribution in §3.4, the ratio shift of §9, the demand-by-demonstration theory of §11.6) has been observed.

12. Conclusion

The Silica Wat food network is offered as an institutional-design pattern available to contemplative-tradition institutions facing analogous food-system questions. The pattern's five components (religious institutional infrastructure; homegrown-amplified contribution layer; conventionally-supplemented baseline; gratitude-economic mediation; doctrinal grounding), three structural problems addressed, critical positioning constraints, and three-phase implementation phasing together specify the architecture at the level a competing design could implement.

The pattern could be piloted first in Cambodia (§2.2), subject to the local legal review of §11.2, and is tractable for adaptation to the global Theravāda diaspora and cross-tradition contexts. The institutional substance requires institutional build-out across the multi-decade horizon; the pattern specifies the form that build-out takes. The food-network arm of the broader middle-way-restoration mission is intended to operate alongside the contemplative-practice arm (the respiratory-biofeedback architecture), the institutional arm (the AGI-monks pattern), and the gratitude-economic arm (the HeartBank platform).

The author and HeartBank® will not seek patent on this specification or any portion thereof, and will not assert any patent right against anyone practising it. The work is offered to the commons under CC0 in the spirit of *dāna*, that all beings may give and receive without barrier.

Terms

Coined names in this paper and the standard technical terms an examiner would use for them.

Term in this paper	Standard technical term
Silica Wat	monastery-based community food site combining a farm, a kitchen and free food distribution
Silica Wat food network	distributed network of religious-institution community kitchens and food-distribution sites
AGI-monk / robot monk	AI agent and robotic system operating a kitchen, farm and inventory as a caretaker
caretaker-not-ordained	operational role for an AI or robot that carries no religious office or ritual authority
homegrown-amplified contribution layer	donated home-garden produce, converted by a shared kitchen into prepared meals
conventionally-supplemented baseline	food purchased through ordinary retail and wholesale channels to guarantee a supply floor
Kiitos	non-monetary peer-to-peer gratitude record between people; not convertible into money
Kiitti	gratitude record addressed to a non-human contributor (land, plants, a product or service), kept by a coordinator that holds no balance
crossing	one recorded act of giving or thanking, counted once and not weighted by what was given
aura	state signal derived from a participant's gratitude ledger oscillating around zero; not a reputation score
Zero / the annual jubilee	the ledger's reference point, and the yearly forgiveness (reset to zero) of every gratitude balance
HeartBank® Stall	unstaffed, robot-operated hand-over point; goods given first, with optional thanks afterwards
B-Tag mode	post-receipt, payment-optional pricing (thanks or pay-what-you-wish after the goods)
Aquarian Pool SM	commons fund that receives thanks having no human addressee
not-a-restaurant positioning	operating a communal meal outside the licensed food-service category, subject to local legal review
<i>dāna</i>	gift-giving, in the Buddhist sense
Sangha	the ordained monastic community

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corpus discloses its AI collaboration; substantive authorship and final editorial control remain with the named author.

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Cross-venue identifiers

- Canonical: thonly.org/research/silica-wat-food-network
 - GitHub: github.com/thonly/publications/blob/main/defensive-publications/silica-wat-food-network.md
 - Companion (institutional voice): [heartbank.net](https://heartbank.net/positions/food-system-pathologies-contemplative-response) position paper *Food-System Pathologies and the Contemplative-Tradition Response* (heartbank.net/positions/food-system-pathologies-contemplative-response)
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